NUSUK CONSULT — Hosting Manual

Last updated: October 2026 (build 20261023a). How the platform was deployed to **https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/** on **Truehost cPanel (Web Hosting Starter)** using *Setup Node.js App*. Follow this to deploy it again, move it, or recover it.

1. What you are deploying

Item	Detail
App	Node.js web app (site + request forms + admin dashboard)
Dependencies	**None** (no `npm install` needed)
Node version	**22.13 or newer** (uses built-in SQLite). Truehost offers 22.23.3. Set the app to **22.x** and **Production** (an older version such as 10.x causes 404/503 errors)
Database	One SQLite file: `nusuk.db` (kept **outside** the code folder)
Entry file	`app.cjs`
URL path	`/nusuk` (set with `BASE_PATH`)

Before you start, confirm:

- ☐ cPanel has **Setup Node.js App** (search "node" in cPanel's tool search)
- ☐ The version list includes **22.13+**
- ☐ The domain's DNS already points to the hosting (A record = the server IP)
- ☐ You have the project ZIP from GitHub

If either of the first two is missing, the app cannot run on that plan — ask the host to enable Node 22, or use a VPS (Appendix A).

2. Folder layout (cPanel home = `/home/<cpanel-user>`)

```
/home/<cpanel-user>/
├── nusuk/                  ← APPLICATION ROOT (code lives here)
│   ├── app.cjs             ← startup file
│   ├── package.json
│   ├── server/             ← index.js, db.js, auth.js, validate.js, config.js
│   ├── public/             ← index.html, css/, js/, img/
│   └── test/
├── nusuk-data/             ← DATABASE (created automatically; never delete)
└── public_html/            ← your main website (not touched)
```

> **Golden rule:** the files `app.cjs`, `server/`, `public/` must sit **directly** inside `nusuk/`, not in a sub-folder.

3. First-time deployment

Step 1 — Download the project

1. Open the GitHub repository → choose the branch → **Code** → **Download ZIP**.
2. You get `Nusuk-<branch>.zip`.

Step 2 — Upload the code

1. cPanel → **File Manager**.
2. Go to `/home/<cpanel-user>` and create a folder named `nusuk`.
3. Open `nusuk` → **Upload** → select the ZIP.
4. Right-click the ZIP → **Extract** (into `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk`).
5. Open the new folder (`Nusuk-<branch>`), **Select All** → **Move** to `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk`. (Turn on **Settings** → **Show Hidden Files** first.)
6. Delete the empty extracted folder and the ZIP.
7. Check the layout matches section 2.

Step 3 — Create the Node.js app

cPanel → **Setup Node.js App** → **Create Application**:

Field	Value
Node.js version	**22.x** (e.g. 22.23.3)
Application mode	Production
Application root	`nusuk`
Application URL	pick your domain, and type `nusuk` in the path box next to it
Application startup file	`app.cjs`

> ⚠️ Do not leave the path box empty — the site will return 404.

Environment variables (Add variable for each):

Name	Value	Meaning
`BASE_PATH`	`/nusuk`	Serve under `/nusuk`
`HTTPS`	`1`	Secure cookies (site must use https)
`ADMIN_EMAIL`	your email	First administrator login
`ADMIN_PASSWORD`	a strong password (10+ chars)	First administrator password
`DATA_DIR`	`/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk-data`	Database location (outside `public_html`)

Click **Create**, then **Start/Restart**.

> `ADMIN_EMAIL` / `ADMIN_PASSWORD` are only read the **first time** the app starts. Change the password later in **Dashboard** → **Users**, not here.
> ⚠️ **Do not add** `PAYSTACK_SECRET_KEY` **as a cPanel variable.** It broke the site once. Put it in a `.env` file instead (section 4b). Also confirm the version is **22.x** and the mode is **Production** — an old Node version (for example 10.24) makes the site show 404 or 503.

Step 4 — Fix the `.htaccess` (required on Truehost)

Truehost adds a WordPress rewrite block that sends every non-file URL to a missing `index.php`. That blocks the app's API (`/nusuk/api/...`) and gives a 404.

1. File Manager → **Settings** → **Show Hidden Files**.
2. Find the `.htaccess` that contains lines starting `PassengerAppRoot` (cPanel created it when you made the app — in `public_html` or `public_html/nusuk`).
3. **Copy** it first as a backup (`.htaccess.bak`).
4. Edit it and **delete only** the block shown below.

```
# BEGIN WordPress
RewriteEngine On
RewriteBase /
RewriteRule ^index\.php$ - [L]
RewriteCond %{REQUEST_FILENAME} !-f
RewriteCond %{REQUEST_FILENAME} !-d
RewriteRule . /index.php [L]
# END WordPress
```

Keep the Passenger lines, the HTTPS redirect and the security rules, then continue:

5. Save, then **Restart** the Node app.

Step 5 — Verify

1. Open `https://www.<domain>/nusuk/api/health` → must show `{"ok":true}` .
2. Open `https://www.<domain>/nusuk/` (keep the trailing slash) → the site loads.
3. Open `/nusuk/#/login` → sign in with `ADMIN_EMAIL` / `ADMIN_PASSWORD` .
4. **Immediately** change the admin password: **Dashboard** → **Users** → **Edit**.
5. Submit a test request on the Interest Form and confirm it appears in **Dashboard** → **Service Requests**.

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4. First-time setup inside the dashboard

1. **Users** → change your password; add staff accounts if needed (`staff` cannot see Users/Settings).
2. **Settings** → **Platform FX rate** → enter Naira per 1 Saudi Riyal (shown in the top bar; hidden until set).
3. **Settings** → **Brochures / YouTube** → add the links (buttons stay disabled until filled). Visitors must enter an email before a brochure opens; the emails collect in **Dashboard** → **Email List**.

4. **Settings** → **Umrah visa fees** → enter the adult visa fee and service fee (₦); child/infant fees are optional (blank = adult fee). Until the adult fee is set, clients see "fees confirmed by our team".
5. **Offers** → add your bed space and mutawef offers so the Offers tab on the booking page is ready (section 4b).

4b. DIY Booking (hotels, offers, HHR train, transfers) and the Email List

- **Payments are manual by default.** No extra settings are needed: a client reserves a hotel or offer, receives a slip marked *payment pending*, your team contacts them, and you click **Mark as PAID** on the order (Dashboard → DIY Orders).
- **Pay Now and Pay Later.** Once Paystack is on, hotel, bed space and mutawef bookings show **Pay Now** (Paystack: card, bank transfer, USSD) and **Pay Later** (reservation, your team collects payment). Both create a booking slip straight away.
- **Before clients can book hotels:** set the **Platform FX rate** (Settings) and add hotels (Dashboard → Hotel Inventory — add one by one, or bulk-upload the Excel template). Set your default **mark-up %** in Settings.
- **Offers tab (Dashboard → Offers):**
  - *Bed space offers:* title, offer (e.g. 1 Bed Space for Men), location, hotel stars, check-in, check-out (nights are calculated), total price and a cover image. They hide automatically after check-out.
  - *Mutawef offers:* title, description, sightseeing stops (one per line), price per sightseeing service and a cover image. Customers tick the stops they want; the total is the price multiplied by the stops chosen.
  - Use the **Live** tick to hide an offer without deleting it.
  - Offer bookings appear in **DIY Orders** (types *Bed Space* and *Mutawef*); mark them **PAID**, then **Fulfilled**.
- **Email List (Dashboard → Email List):** brochure downloads ask for an email first. Each unique email is stored with its download history; use **Export CSV** to import it into your email tool, and delete an address on request.
- **Uploads on shared hosting:** hotel and offer images and files are stored next to the database (`nusuk-data/media` and `nusuk-data/offers`) — they are included when you back up `nusuk-data`.
- **Turning on Paystack:**
  1. In **File Manager** turn on *Show Hidden Files*, open `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk` and create a file named `.env` (a dot at the start, no extension).
  2. Put one line in it, with no spaces and no quotes: `PAYSTACK_SECRET_KEY=sk_test_…` (use the **test** key first, the **live** key when ready).
  3. Make sure `PUBLIC_URL=https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk` is set (in `.env` or as a cPanel variable) and set the Paystack webhook to `https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/api/paystack/webhook`.

4. **Restart** the app, then use **Settings → Check Paystack connection**. The Payments line must say *Paystack (online)*.
5. Never share screenshots showing the secret key. If a key was ever exposed, regenerate it in Paystack and replace it in `.env`.

- **If `.env` is deleted by mistake:** the site keeps working but payments fall back to manual. Recreate the file as above and restart.

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5. Updating the live site (after new changes)

Option A — small update pack (recommended). You receive a ZIP that contains only the changed files, in their correct folders (`public/...`, `server/...`).

1. **Back up** `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk-data/nusuk.db` (File Manager → Download).
2. Upload the pack into `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk`, **Extract** it and choose **Overwrite**, then delete the ZIP.
3. **Setup Node.js App → Restart.**
4. Open `/nusuk/api/health` and check the new build number, then hard-refresh the site (**Ctrl+Shift+R**).

Option B — full replacement from GitHub.

1. **Back up** `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk-data/nusuk.db`.
2. Download the new ZIP from GitHub.
3. In `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk` **delete**: folders `public`, `server`, `test`; files `app.cjs`, `package.json`, `README.md`, `Dockerfile`. **Never delete:** `tmp`, the `.env` file, and the separate `nusuk-data` folder.
4. Upload the ZIP → Extract → Select All inside the extracted folder → **Move** to `nusuk` → delete the leftovers.
5. **Setup Node.js App → Restart.**
6. Test `/nusuk/api/health`, then hard-refresh the site (**Ctrl+Shift+R**).

Only changed `public/` files (HTML/CSS/JS/images)? No restart is needed — upload and hard-refresh. *Changed anything in `server/` or `app.cjs`?* Restart the app.

Editing a text by hand? Change the file in File Manager, then bump the build number (`BUILD`) in three places so browsers load the new file: `server/config.js`, the first line of `public/js/app.js`, and `public/index.html` (twice). Restart, then hard-refresh.

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6. Backups and recovery

- **Back up:** download `nusuk-data/nusuk.db` regularly (weekly, and before every update). It holds all requests, bookings, users, inventory and settings.
- **Restore:** upload the saved `nusuk.db` back into `nusuk-data/` and restart the app.
- **Lost admin password:** in File Manager, rename `nusuk-data/nusuk.db` to `nusuk.db.old`, set new `ADMIN_EMAIL` / `ADMIN_PASSWORD` variables, restart (a new empty database and admin are created). Re-import is not automatic — keep the old file for reference.

7. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
`hausaly.com/nusuk/` → black **404** page	Application URL path empty, or code one folder too deep	Set path `nusuk` and Save; fix layout (section 2)
Page loads but login says **"Request failed"**	App not receiving API calls (WordPress rule in `.htaccess`) or app not running	Step 4; Restart; check `/api/health`
`/api/health` → 404	Same as above	Step 4
`/api/health` → 500/503 or "Incomplete response"	App crashed on start	Open `nusuk/stderr.log` and `nusuk/boot.log` in File Manager
No `boot.log` appears	cPanel is not running `app.cjs`	Check startup file name, application root, app is Started
Login works but you are logged out at once	`HTTPS=1` but visiting `http://`	Use `https://`
Old design / old page still showing	Files not replaced, or a cached copy	Open `/nusuk/api/health` and note `"build"`; then open `/nusuk/js/app.js` — its first line says `const BUILD='…'`. Same number = files are current → **Ctrl+Shift+R**. Different = the upload didn't replace the files (re-do the update steps) or the Node app wasn't restarted
`.htaccess` block comes back	Truehost regenerated it	Repeat Step 4
Node version list tops out below 22	Plan limitation	Ask the host to enable Node 22, or use a VPS
404 or 503 after a change, app on an old Node (e.g. 10.24)	Wrong Node version or mode	Set Node **22.x** and **Production**, Save, Restart
503 right after adding `PAYSTACK_SECRET_KEY` as a cPanel variable	Variable broke the start-up	Delete the variable, put the key in `.env` (section 4b), Restart
Payments show "Manual" or "Test mode" instead of Paystack	`.env` missing, misspelt or deleted	Recreate `.env` with `PAYSTACK_SECRET_KEY=…`, Restart
Edited a file by hand but nothing changes	Cached copy	Bump the build number in `server/config.js`, `public/js/app.js` and `public/index.html`, Restart, Ctrl+F5

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Brochure button asks for an email and the link doesn't open	Link not set, or pop-up blocked	Add the link in Settings; use the "click here to open it" link in the thank-you box

Diagnostic files (in `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk/`):

- `boot.log` — written by `app.cjs`: startup info, errors, first 30 requests.
- `stderr.log` — written by cPanel: the app's error output. Delete both once everything works.

Useful checks

- Health: `/nusuk/api/health` → `{"ok":true}`
- cPanel → **Metrics** → **Errors** shows recent Apache errors.

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8. Security checklist

- ☐ Admin password changed from the one used at first start
- ☐ Never share screenshots showing environment-variable values (they include the password)
- ☐ `DATA_DIR` is **outside** `public_html`
- ☐ Site is served over **https** and `HTTPS=1` is set
- ☐ Staff accounts use the `staff` role, not `admin`
- ☐ Database backed up and stored off the server
- ☐ Paystack key lives in `.env` (not in a cPanel variable) and was regenerated if ever exposed
- ☐ The email list is exported only for permitted marketing and addresses are removed on request

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Appendix A — Deploying on a VPS instead (Docker)

```
git clone https://github.com/<owner>/Nusuk && cd Nusuk
docker build -t nusuk-consult .
docker run -d --name nusuk --restart=always -p 127.0.0.1:3000:3000 -v nusuk-data:/data \
  -e BASE_PATH=/nusuk -e HTTPS=1 -e ADMIN_EMAIL=you@example.com -e
ADMIN_PASSWORD='StrongPassword' nusuk-consult
```

Reverse-proxy `/nusuk` (path unchanged) to `127.0.0.1:3000`:

```
# Caddy
www.example.com { handle /nusuk* { reverse_proxy 127.0.0.1:3000 } }
```

```
# nginx
location /nusuk/ { proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:3000; proxy_set_header Host $host;
proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-For $remote_addr; }
location = /nusuk { return 301 /nusuk/; }
```

Leave `BASE_PATH` empty to serve at the domain root or on a subdomain.

Appendix B — Environment variable reference

Variable	Default	Purpose
`PORT`	3000	Listening port (cPanel/Passenger overrides it)
`DATA_DIR`	`./data`	Folder for `nusuk.db`
`BASE_PATH`	*(empty)*	Sub-path, e.g. `/nusuk`
`HTTPS`	0	`1` = secure cookies, trust proxy headers
`ADMIN_EMAIL`	admin@nusuk.com.ng	First admin email (first start only)
`ADMIN_PASSWORD`	*(random, printed once)*	First admin password (first start only)
`PUBLIC_URL`	*(empty)*	Public site address, e.g. `https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk` (needed for Paystack return links)
`PAYSTACK_SECRET_KEY`	*(empty)*	Turns on Pay Now. **Put it in** `.env`, not as a cPanel variable
`PAYMENT_SIMULATION`	*(empty)*	`1` = simulated test payments. **Never set on the live site**
`NOTIFY_WEBHOOK_URL`	*(empty)*	Optional JSON notification on each new request/booking

Variables can be set in cPanel or in a `.env` file inside `/home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk` (one `NAME=value` per line, no quotes). Real environment variables win over `.env`.

Appendix C — Quick reference

```
Site:         https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/
Admin login:  https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/#/login
Health:       https://www.hausaly.com/nusuk/api/health
App root:     /home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk        startup file: app.cjs
Database:     /home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk-data/nusuk.db
Paystack key: /home/<cpanel-user>/nusuk/.env  (PAYSTACK_SECRET_KEY=...)
Restart:      cPanel → Setup Node.js App → Restart
```